DRAFT

COM-002

Radio Usage and Etiquette

Use clear, brief calls on your assigned channel. These habits apply across radio models; programming is covered separately in COM-009.

! WARNING — URGENT ACTION

Life safety comes first. Call 911 when available for immediate danger. A radio call does not mean emergency services have been notified. Do not delay evacuation or enter a hazard to make a report.

BEFORE YOU TRANSMIT

- ☐ Battery charged; spare or charging cable ready
- ☐ Antenna secure; volume audible
- ☐ Assigned channel selected; callsign known
- ☐ Receive checked; transmit only if authorized
- ☐ Push-to-talk protected from accidental use

- **Listen first.** Wait for a clear channel.
- **Press, pause, speak.** Use a normal voice; follow your microphone guide.
- **Release and listen.** Leave room for urgent calls.
- **Stay professional.** Avoid private details and speculation.

COMMON RADIO PHRASES

Phrase	Meaning
Roger / Copy	Message received. Read back critical details to confirm understanding.
Affirmative / Negative	Yes / No.
Over	Finished speaking; a reply is expected.
Out	Exchange finished; no reply expected. Do not say “over and out.”
Stand by / Standing by	Please wait / I am waiting and ready.
Go ahead	Send your message; I am listening.
Say again	Please repeat your message or the specified part.
Correction / Disregard	Correcting my message / Ignore my previous message.
Radio check / Loud and clear	Can you hear me? / Your audio is clear.
Emergency traffic	Urgent call requesting priority; follow the team's procedure.

Use plain language: “What is your location?” Acknowledgment does not mean a task is complete.

SOURCES

SAMPLE TEXT — NOT APPROVED ADVICE. Fire Watch brief (September 24) and supplied quick-reference pages (October 23, 2026).

Radio Calls and Emergency Traffic

On a directed net, Net Control coordinates calls. Listen, wait to be recognized, and report the essential facts.

MAKE A ROUTINE CALL

1. **Call and identify:** “Net Control, [callsign].” Release and wait for “Go ahead.” If unanswered, pause and try once more.
2. **Report** location, observation, time, threats, action taken, and help needed. Identify unconfirmed information.
3. **Confirm.** Read back critical details; ask “Say again” if unclear. End with your callsign; resume monitoring.

⌖ **LOCAL INFORMATION — VERIFY BEFORE APPROVAL**

[VERIFY] Fire Watch identification: Use your assigned three-digit callsign and any legally required station ID. Address city personnel by title. Outside a net, call the member directly: “145, 238.” Wait for “238, go ahead.”

GIVE EMERGENCY TRAFFIC PRIORITY

! WARNING — URGENT ACTION

Urgent danger: At a break, say **“Emergency traffic, [callsign].”** Release and listen for acknowledgment, then give the exact location and danger first. Other stations hold routine calls. If unanswered, use another available way to summon help.

Confirm the interruption phrase before duty: the existing brief uses **“Emergency traffic”**; the supplied sheet uses “Break, break.”

SOURCES

SAMPLE TEXT — NOT APPROVED ADVICE. Fire Watch operational brief and supplied quick-reference pages. Confirm local procedures before duty.

Radio Check and Field Call Examples

Practice with your assigned callsign. Replace bracketed fields with confirmed facts and exact locations.

SAMPLE RADIO CHECK

When the channel is clear and checks are permitted:
You: “Fire Watch, this is [callsign]. Radio check. Over.”
Other station: “[Callsign], loud and clear. Over.”
You: “Copy. [Callsign], out.”

ROUTINE REPORT

You: “Net Control, [callsign].”
Net Control: “[Callsign], go ahead.”
You: “Visible smoke near [exact location], first seen [time]. [Observed conditions]. [Help needed]. Over.”
You: Read back instructions when received; close with “[Callsign], out.”

EMERGENCY REPORT

You: “Emergency traffic, [callsign].”
Net Control: “All stations hold. [Callsign], go ahead.”
You: “[Exact location]. Active fire. [People or access threatened]. [Action taken]. [Help needed]. Over.”

Blocked road: give street/intersection, obstruction, and passability. Report from safety.

MONITOR UPDATES AND CHECK OUT

⌖ **LOCAL INFORMATION — VERIFY BEFORE APPROVAL**

[VERIFY] Net Control updates: High activity: :00, :15, :30, :45; quieter: :00, :30; stand-down: :00 hourly. Hold routine calls for updates; follow current net instructions.

Ask to check out or report a channel/radio change before leaving the net. After duty, report equipment problems and recharge. Neighborhood radio coordination does not replace official emergency instructions.

SOURCES

SAMPLE TEXT — NOT APPROVED ADVICE. Fire Watch brief and supplied pages. Verify local procedures. Programming: COM-009; UV-PRO: COM-008.